Deon Grover

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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity graduate (1st Class Honours) from Keele University specialising in vulnerability detection, offensive security tooling, and cloud application security. Award-winning researcher whose dissertation extended OWASP ZAP with a custom payload library, increasing detected SQL injection vulnerabilities by 218% over the default payload set. Holds Microsoft AZ-204 (Azure Developer Associate), with hands-on experience across identity and access management, secrets handling with Key Vault, event-driven architecture and application monitoring, and keeps offensive skills current through TryHackMe labs covering SQL injection, XSS, privilege escalation and network-based attacks. Seeking a Junior Security Analyst role to apply research-led, cloud-aware methodologies to enterprise threat detection and secure application development.

Education

Keele University *Sept 2022 - July 2025*

BSc Computer Science (Cyber Security)

- Grade: 1st Class Honours
- Dissertation: "Enhancing SQL Injection Detection in OWASP ZAP using Custom Payload Fuzzing"
- Engineered a custom SQLi detection pipeline in OWASP ZAP using custom payload fuzzing
- Conducted structured vulnerability assessments using WebGoat environments
- Awarded Best Poster at Keele Town Hall; nominated Student of the Year 2025
- Dissertation co-publishing with Dr. Amro Al-Said Ahmad

Projects

Dissertation: SQLi Vulnerability Detection Enhancement in OWASP ZAP (Sept 2024 - July 2025)

- Built a context-aware payload library of 1,429 payloads covering Boolean, time-delay, error, union, blind, nested and encoded vectors, with obfuscation via Base64, Unicode and hexadecimal
- Increased detected SQL injection vulnerabilities by 218% against ZAP's default payload set (388 detections versus 122) in a controlled OWASP WebGoat testbed, and raised payload reflection rate from 18.7% to 27.2%
- Ran target and tooling in Docker for reproducible, isolated experiments, with Python automation exporting results to CSV and JSON for analysis
- Awarded Best Poster at Keele Town Hall; nominated Student of the Year 2025.

Microsoft Azure Cloud Application - "AZ-204 Developer Associate" (May 2026)

- Deployed and managed a scalable web application on Azure App Service, configuring SSL, diagnostics logging and autoscaling for production-grade reliability
- Implemented identity and access controls with the Microsoft Identity Platform and Azure AD, including OAuth 2.0 flows, shared access signatures and role-based access control
- Secured application secrets and credentials in Azure Key Vault with key rotation and certificate handling
- Configured observability and alerting via Application Insights and Azure Monitor, tracking failed requests and performance anomalies to support proactive incident response
- Implemented Azure API Management with authentication policies and rate limiting to enforce defence in depth

Agentic AI Hackathon, Microsoft Foundry (June 2026)

- Built multi-agent AI applications using Microsoft Foundry, Azure OpenAI and the Microsoft Agent Framework as part of Microsoft's Cloud & AI Frontier Week
- Orchestrated multi-agent workflows with Foundry IQ for multi-step business automation
- Attended live sessions across both days and completed the required projects to earn the AI Agent Master badge

Interactive CV Website (July 2026 - October 2026)

- https://portfolio-nine-roan-3b8pahbp36.vercel.app
- Built and deployed a personal site from scratch in Next.js 16, TypeScript and Tailwind CSS, statically prerendered on Vercel
- Hardened all responses with CSP, HSTS, Permissions-Policy, Referrer-Policy, frame-ancestors, nosniff and COOP, scoring grade A on securityheaders.com
- Defended the contact form in three layers: a validation schema shared by client and server, a honeypot that returns success rather than a validation error so bots gain no signal, and IP-based rate limiting applied before validation
- Published an RFC 9116 security.txt disclosure contact, and documented every engineering decision including known limitations in the public repository
- Wrote 14 unit tests and a GitHub Actions pipeline running lint, typecheck, test and build on every push

Technical Skills

- Security Tools: OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite, Wireshark
- Offensive & Defensive: SQLi testing, manual payload fuzzing, DAST, web application pentesting, vulnerability scanning, incident response, log analysis, cyber threat intelligence, secrets management
- Cloud & Infrastructure: Microsoft Azure (App Service, Functions, Key Vault, Azure AD, Service Bus, Event Hub, Event Grid, Cosmos DB, Blob Storage, Container Registry, APIM, Application Insights, Azure Monitor, ARM templates), Docker
- Languages: Python, SQL, Java, C++, TypeScript, HTML
- Systems & Environments: Windows, Docker, WebGoat, XAMPP, Azure Portal, Git

Certifications

Microsoft:

- AZ-204: Microsoft Certified Azure Developer Associate - App Service, Azure Functions, Key Vault, Azure AD, Service Bus, Event Hub, Event Grid, Cosmos DB, Blob Storage, Container Registry, APIM, Application Insights, Azure Monitor
- Agentic AI Hackathon: AI Agent Master (June 2026) - Microsoft Foundry, Azure OpenAI, Microsoft Agent Framework, Foundry IQ

IBM:

- IBM Cyber Threat Intelligence
- IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Assessment
- IBM Cybersecurity Capstone: Breach Response Case Studies
- IBM Penetration Testing, Incident Response and Forensics
- IBM Network Security & Database Vulnerabilities
- IBM Introduction to Cybersecurity Tools & Cyberattacks
- IBM Operating Systems: Overview, Administration and Security